

WHAT GEN Z DOES

• The biggest chunk is still studying, showing the potential of this group to push consumption whenever they join the workforce

Activity	2024-25 (Million)	%	Share of Rural (%)
• Farming	10	2.40	90
• Salaried	42	9.9	44
• Business	59	14.1	51
• Casual labour	52	12.3	71
• Homemaker	46	11.1	64
• Students	113	26.8	68
• Did not work but was seeking	25	6	68
• Helper in household enterprise	33	7.9	70
• Others	40	9.5	56
• Total	420	100	65

SOURCE PRICE ICE 360° RESEARCH PAPER, AUGUST 2025

reimagine its core brands. Specifically, she picked beauty, a key part of HUL's portfolio, and the view was that it was not enough to have just higher brand equity.

"Today, we have almost 400 million Gen Z consumers in India, and they are indeed driving change and transformation. So, we reimagine the brands. We need them to be more modern and more youthful," she said. Importantly, Nair said brands need to be examined comprehensively—from packaging and positioning to product and renovation—across both core offerings and premium innovations, to stay relevant in a changing India.

Clearly, this requires a very incisive and nuanced understanding, one that is different from how marketing was done in the past. Ashish Goupal, CEO – India Core Business, Marico, outlines how his company, known for brands such as Parachute, Saffola, Nihar, Livon and Set Wet, believes that the Gen Z cohort "is particularly interesting from a business opportunity perspective" as it seeks brands that reflect their identity, values and fast-paced lifestyles.

"They just don't demand relevant products but crave authenticity. Their preference for digital engagement and experiential consumption opens new avenues for innovation and growth," he says.

The BT-PRICE Survey analysed purchase behaviour of the Gen Z cohort, found a clear decision hierarchy, driven "primarily by product quality, value perception and brand trust, rather than impulse or trend-following." Among metro residents, graduates and higher-income groups, this emerges

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WHAT THEY EARN

• Nearly 40% Gen Z have some form of regular income

	Rural	Urban	Total
• Total youth population (million)	276	144	420
• Share of youth (%)	66%	34%	100%
• Share of youth earning personal income (%)	38.5%	41.8%	39.6%
• Average annual income of youth (₹)	1,28,000	2,19,000	1,59,000
• Contribution of youth to household income (%)	31.4%	32.4%	31.8%

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